Alignment Map Purpose

Few issues in the world of role-playing games are as contentious as the concept of alignment. For many, it is an outdated concept that reduces character personality into a box that is too small. For others, it is an essential piece of information that is vital to a character's place in the cosmos and the larger battle between good and evil.

This worksheet is designed to help GMs and players flesh out their character's personality in a quick and easy to use format. It functions as an analysis of a character's behavior, which happens to line up with the traditional alignment system.

For games that rely on the alignment system, this worksheet will help determine a character's alignment without reducing them to stereotypes usually associated with that alignment. Two characters may have similar final alignment scores, but still have very different traits and personalities.

For games that don't actively use the alignment system, the map can still be used to quickly outline character traits and quirks. Even when the alignment system is not used, the map can still be useful when considering how a character might be seen in a typical society.

Using the Map

In each category, look at the traits in each alignment section and rate how much that trait applies to your character. A zero means the trait does not describe the character at all, while a four means the trait describes the character extremely well. A well rounded character will have some traits in each section–after all, few people are purely good or purely evil.

After filling out each trait, add the totals of each section, and determine the difference between your good and evil scores, and your chaos and law scores. If you have a difference between them of four or more, you are considered to be whichever alignment you scored higher on. If the difference between the two is three or less, you are considered to be neutral.

For example, a character has 8 good, 4 evil, 2 chaos and 4 lawful. This character has a net 4 good and 2 lawful, making the character neutral good.

Shifting Traits

Over the course of a narrative arc, it is natural and good that a character's personality and values change. Each time you gain a level, it is worth considering how the character's experiences have changed them. For example, after a serious betrayal, a paladin's trust score needs to be reduced. Perhaps a rogue who previously was always looking out for themselves might have learned the value of friendship, and needs to increase their loyalty score. Over time, you might discover that your character's alignment has changed significantly from when you started!

Using the Map During Play

This map can also serve as an alternative to the flaw/bond method of providing Inspiration to players. Players choose their highest traits that they think best represent their character and share this information with the GM. When a character performs according to these traits, the GM might occasionally impose advantage or disadvantage on certain rolls. When a GM does impose disadvantage on a roll in this way, the player should be rewarded with Inspiration, to be used at a later time.

A GM can also reward Inspiration to players who are roleplaying well according to their alignment map. While the players ultimately decide their characters personality, GMs should have knowledge of their character's traits and consider them when designing encounters.

When using this method, GM's should also occasionally find ways to apply it to NPCs that their players encounter as well. For example, the players may be able to find a way to exploit an antogonist who is extremely vain.

Sample Characters

Below are two sample characters whose traits defy traditional expectations of their alignment.

Meredith Longfellow

Lawful Good Freedom Fighter

13 Good: *Altruistic 3, Charitable 2, Compassionate 2, Friendly 2, Idealistic 2, Pure 2*

9 Evil: *Jealous 4, Deceitful 2, Wrathful 1, Vain 2*

9 Chaos: *Cunning 2, Emotional 3, Rebellious 4*

16 Law: *Dedicated 4, Loyal 2, Organized 4, Prudent 2, Strategic 3*

Meredith is a fighter who has joined a local rebellion. She sincerely fights against the oppressive king with dreams of peace in her heart. However, a longstanding rivalry with her sister has given her an inferiority complex. Living under an oppressive regime has made her distrustful of authority figures and the rule of law, however, she is highly organized, a careful planner and an expert tactician.

Roderick Redsail

Chaotic Neutral Sherriff

11 Good: *Charitable 4, Friendly 3, Generous 4*

11 Evil: *Arrogant 2, Deceitful 3, Gluttonous 3, Jealous 3*

17 Chaos: *Cunning 3, Daring 3, Easy-Going 3, Flexible 2, Impulsive 3, Nomadic 3*

6 Law: *Law-Abiding 3, Obedient 1, Organized 2*

Roderick Redsail is an an official deputy who has made a name for himself by working for a local king finding criminals. He likes being the center of attention and the life of the party, but is a bit full of himself. Even though his life is tumultuous, he takes pride in his work and considers himself a professional, even claiming credentials given by the local duke.

Ordo Everwinter

Lawful Evil Devout Warrior

8 Good: *Charitable 2, Pure 4, Idealistic 1, Trusting 1*

12 Evil: *Aggressive 3, Arrogant 3, Vain 2, Wrathful 4*

5 Chaos: *Daring 2, Discontented 2, Emotional 1*

16 Law: *Dedicated 3, Devout 3, Law-Abiding 3, Loyal 2, Prudent 2, Strategic 2, Temporate 1*

Ordo is a member of the Order of the Purifying Light–a group dedicated to the eradication of demons and their followers. Members of the order must maintain a strict adherence to keeping their bodies pure, abstaining from alcohol and following strict guidelines of food. Ordo is proud of his work with the Order, and has no mercy for those who ally themselves with these dark powers.

Alignment Map

Character Name: Meredith Longfellow

Good

	0	1	2	3	4
Altruistic				X	
Charitable			X		
Compassionate			X		
Forgiving	X				
Friendly			X		
Generous	X				
Idealistic			X		
Pure			X		
Trusting	X				

Total Good: 13

Chaos

	0	1	2	3	4
Cunning			X		
Daring	X				
Discontented	X				
Easy-Going	X				
Flexible	X				
Emotional				X	
Impulsive	X				
Nomadic	X				
Rebellious	X				X

Total Chaos 9

Evil

	0	1	2	3	4
Aggressive	X				
Arrogant	X				
Deceitful			X		
Gluttonous	X				
Jealous					X
Selfish	X				
Slothful	X				
Vain			X		
Wrathful		X			

Total Evil: 9

Law

	0	1	2	3	4
Dedicated					X
Devout	X				
Law-Abiding	X				
Loyal			X		
Obedient	X				
Organized					X
Prudent			X		
Strategic				X	
Temperate	X				

Total Lawful: 16

Good Total: 13

Chaos Total 9

Evil Total: 9

Law Total 16

Final Alignment: Lawful (7) Good (4)

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